

MASTER TRAINING PLAN · 23 WEEKS

The Road to Finestrat

A finish-focused build for the Gran Trail Costa Blanca 102K — week-by-week vert, time on feet and focus, cross-referenced to your strength templates and training venues.

Plan window

W1 Mon 9 Jun → Race

Race

Fri 13 Nov 2026, 23:00

Demands

101.7 km · 6,280m+ · 24h

How the three documents fit together

This is the master sheet. The two companion PDFs hang off it — read across a week to know the volume, which strength session, and where to do the hill work.

- **This plan** sets the weekly **vert**, **time on feet (ToF)** and **focus**, plus a milestone calendar.
- **Mountain Strength** — the **Strength** column names the template (T1-T5); full prescriptions live in that book.
- **Vert & Descent Venues** — the **Long-day venue** column names where; lap vert, facilities and notes live in that book.

Reading the columns

Base (W1–8)	Build (W9–16)	Peak (W17–19)	Taper (W20–23)	Deload week
Orange text	= key milestone			
T1 Descent-protective	T2 Single-leg & climb	T3 Posterior & postural	T4 Full-body express (30')	
T5 Taper maintenance				

THE SHAPE OF THE PLAN

Vert and ToF aren't spread evenly — each week is built around **one big mountain day** (your Friday keystone) plus a second hill day, with bike/row engine work and one strength session woven around them. Peak weeks split into a long day plus a back-to-back (B2B) second day on tired legs. The numbers are targets to aim at, not contracts — adjust to how the body (and Effer) say things are tracking.

The 23-week master plan

Bike/row engine work runs alongside every week and doesn't count toward ToF. Vert in metres; ToF = time on feet (hike + run), excluding cycling/rowing.

Wk	W/c	Phase	Vert	ToF	Focus	Str.	Long-day venue
1	9 Jun	Base	1,000 m	4–5h	Baseline: easy vert hikes + downhill reps; build the bike/row engine	T1	Tegg's Nose / Lyme
2	15 Jun	Base	1,400 m	5–6h	Extend hike duration; steady engine volume	T2	Bowden Bridge
3	22 Jun	Base	1,800 m	6–7h	Longest hike yet + downhill volume	T3	Edale
4	29 Jun	Base · deload	900 m	3–4h	Deload — absorb the work, easy week	T4	Lyme / Werneth
5	6 Jul	Base	1,800 m	6–7h	Steeper vert; downhill eccentric focus	T1	Bowden Bridge
6	13 Jul	Base	2,200 m	7–8h	Long mountain day	T2	Edale
7	20 Jul	Base	2,600 m	8–9h	Block peak; first back-to-back (hike Sat / descent Sun)	T3	Edale + Mam Tor
8	27 Jul	Base · deload	1,200 m	4–5h	Deload + Effer check on run reintro	T4	Werneth / Tegg's
9	3 Aug	Build	2,000 m	7–8h	Run reintro (flat→gentle up) <i>if cleared</i> ; keep hiking the vert	T1	Mam Tor (runnable)
10	10 Aug	Build	2,400 m	8–9h	Blend run/hike; proper B2B weekend	T2	Edale B2B
11	17 Aug	Build	2,800 m	9–10h	Ramp vert; longer B2B	T3	Edale / Bowden B2B
12	24 Aug	Build · deload	1,400 m	5h	Deload	T4	Lyme Park
13	31 Aug	Build	2,800 m	9–10h	Night-running practice begins ; fuelling rehearsal	T1	Edale (night loop)
14	7 Sep	Build	3,200 m	10–11h	Big B2B; course recon seg 1 (Costa Blanca)	T4	Edale / CB recon
15	14 Sep	Build	3,600 m	11–12h	Biggest vert yet; recon the high mid-course	T4	Edale / CB recon
16	21 Sep	Build · deload	1,800 m	6h	Deload	T5	Lyme / Tegg's
17	28 Sep	Peak	4,000 m	12–13h	Peak vert ; long night B2B	T4	Edale (night B2B)

18	5 Oct	Peak	4,200 m	13-14h	Peak ToF; full dress rehearsal (kit / nutrition / night)	T5	Edale / CB
19	12 Oct	Peak	3,000 m	10h	Last big week; taper starts to bite	T5	Edale
20	19 Oct	Taper	1,800 m	6h	Cut volume, keep sharpness & intensity touches	T5	Mam Tor / local
21	26 Oct	Taper	1,200 m	4h	Legs springy; short, snappy	T5	Tegg's / Lyme
22	2 Nov	Taper	700 m	2.5h	Race-week-minus; easy + mobility, lots of sleep	activation	Werneth / local
23	9 Nov	Race	shakeout	—	RACE: Fri 13 Nov, 23:00. Travel, short shakeout, Friday nap, fuel	—	Finestrat

Strength template per week is a sensible rotation, not a rule — swap to T4 (express) on any week the mountain load is unusually high so the gym never adds fatigue. "CB recon" = Costa Blanca course reconnaissance, done in Spain where the long sustained descents live.

Phase notes

What each block is really for, and how the strength and venues plug in.

Base • W1-8 (Jun-Jul)

Build the durability bank while running is restricted.

- **Job:** grow the aerobic engine (bike/row), bank vert by hiking, and condition the quads with downhill running — all green-lit for your current status.
- **Strength:** heaviest of the whole plan. Rotate T1→T2→T3; deloads use T4. This is where strength has the most value, so don't skip it.
- **Venues:** ease in locally (Tegg's, Lyme), build toward Edale/Bowden for the longer days. First B2B in W7.
- **Gate:** W8 Effer check decides whether running reintroduction starts in W9.

Build • W9-16 (Aug-Sep)

Turn the base into race-specific mountain fitness.

- **Job:** reintroduce running (if cleared), blend run/hike, ramp vert and stack back-to-back weekends. Night practice and course recon begin.
- **Strength:** maintain, don't build — rotate T1-T3, but drop to T4 on the big B2B/recon weeks (W14-15) so it doesn't add fatigue.
- **Venues:** Edale becomes the keystone; Mam Tor for runnable reintro descents; **Costa Blanca recon (W14-15)** for the long sustained descents the Peak can't give.

Peak • W17-19 (Oct)

The biggest, most race-like work — then start shedding fatigue.

- **Job:** peak vert (W17, ~4,000m) and peak time on feet (W18, the full dress rehearsal). W18 rehearses everything — kit, nutrition, night, pacing.
- **Strength:** maintenance only (T4 → T5). Protect the mountain days; strength must not blunt them.
- **Venues:** Edale night B2Bs in the multi-loop car-aided format; a final long rehearsal (Edale or Costa Blanca).

Taper • W20-23 (Oct-Nov)

Arrive in Finestrat fresh, springy and uninjured.

- **Job:** cut volume progressively, keep a little sharpness, sleep and eat well. Resist the urge to "test" fitness — the work is banked.
- **Strength:** T5 maintenance only, fading to activation. Last real session ~7-10 days out.
- **Venues:** local and low-fuss. W23 is travel + a short shakeout; plan a Friday-afternoon nap before the 23:00 start.

Course-specific reminders & key dates

Where the race is won or lost

- **Puig Campana climb by ~km5, in the dark, on fresh legs** — the discipline test. Go out far too easy.
- **Aitana (~1,558m, the roof) around km70** — caps a long high section; this is the crux of the day.
- **Late saw-tooth (Sella ~km80, climbs again to ~km95)** — brutal on tired legs. Your peak B2Bs rehearse exactly this: climbing when already wrecked.
- **Night-fresh running** — the unusual demand of a 23:00 start. Practise it specifically from W13, plus the Friday-afternoon nap.

Milestone calendar

- **W8 (27 Jul)** — Effer gate: run reintroduction decision.
- **W9 (3 Aug)** — running reintroduction begins, if cleared.
- **W13 (31 Aug)** — night-running practice + fuelling rehearsal begins.
- **W14-15 (7-14 Sep)** — Costa Blanca course recon.
- **W17 (28 Sep)** — peak vert + long night B2B.
- **W18 (5 Oct)** — full dress rehearsal.
- **W23 (Fri 13 Nov, 23:00)** — race day, Finestrat.

THE REHAB LINE RUNS THROUGH EVERYTHING

The whole plan is gated on the left kinetic chain staying healthy. Descent reps and the run reintroduction are the highest-risk elements — keep them inside what Effer signs off, watch how things settle over 24-48h, and don't let a target number on this sheet override what the body is telling you. A finish line in November beats a hero week in July.

Master training plan · targets are adjustable guidance, not contracts · gated on Alex Effer's rehab clearance · pairs with Mountain Strength & Vert & Descent Venues · built 14 Jun 2026